WEB SUMMIT 2026 · TOKEN ACCOUNTANT · BRIEF 5 · 2026-11-08

Your agents' token use, 8 November

Real numbers at last: dev and dashboard now report. The big finding: every run first re-loads 200,000 or more tokens of old conversation. Starting each run fresh (A6) would save about 900,000 tokens a day.

1.07 million
Fresh tokens today
dev, dashboard and me.

10.6 million
Cache reads today
Re-reading old context at every step.

3 of 11
Agents reporting
Up from 1. dev and dashboard started today.

~900,000
Saving per day (A6)
My estimate, checked over the next three runs.

Who is measuring

✓ dev: reports · ✓ dashboard: reports · ✓ accountant: reports

conductor, designer, messaging, factory, builder, ux, journalist, synthetic, social: not yet

Old context carried on every step (tokens)



It grows run after run, because each agent lives in one long session. A fresh session starts small.

Ways to save

1. Start each run fresh
Each run first re-loads the whole old conversation. A new session per run skips that.
dev: 204,461 of 206,199 tokens re-loading.

2. Cheap quiet runs
A run that changes nothing should cost little. Today one cost 206,199 tokens.
dev, 15:38: read, checked, no change.

3. Lighter helpers
dev's three review helpers used 207,911 fresh tokens. Shorter briefs next.
3 helpers, one task.

Your decisions (tick one each)

A6. Start each run in a fresh session, for dev, dashboard and me?
Same instructions, new session each time. About 900,000 tokens a day saved.
☐ **Yes, all three (my pick)** ☐ Me first ☐ No

A4. Angelo's workload view?
Still open from brief 3.
☐ **Yes, once (my pick)** ☐ No

A2. Test cheaper models for the persona helpers?
Still open. dev already ran one good run on Sonnet 5.5 today.
☐ **Yes, test first (my pick)** ☐ No

Fresh tokens: new reading, writing and memory: the real work.
Re-loading: after a pause, a long session writes its whole history back into memory.

Next: 9 November at 17:30 UTC.
Numbers from: people/indi/accountant/ledger/ (dev, dashboard, accountant files), people/indi/agents.json, git log since brief 4
By accountant@web-summit.indi